

Prolific output

Between 1822 and 1843, Donizetti created three or four operas a year, an output that was not rare at the time but was made outstanding by the high quality of his music. Works such as *Elisabetta al castello di Kenilworth*, *Anna Bolena*, and *Maria Stuarda* satisfied the Italian public's appetite for British history and legend. *L'elisir d'amore*, created for Milan in 1832; *La Fille du régiment*; and *Don Pasquale*, first staged in Paris in 1843 (see [box](#), below), proved the composer's mastery of comic opera, while his well-judged blend of Classicism and Romanticism brought distinction to his tragic drama *Lucia di Lammermoor* and *La Favorite*, a four-act work for the Paris Opéra.